

Business Model

How Checkpoint creates value for hotels, lodges and their guests, how it earns revenue, and how it grows.

In one paragraph

Properties pay a monthly subscription per site for private, encrypted guest check-in that also produces the legally required guest register. Guests never pay. We start with registered accommodation in Namibia, beginning at our family's own property, Hotel Etuna in Ongwediva, and grow through lodge groups and hospitality associations. We win by being private by design, usable by every guest whether or not they own a smartphone, able to work offline, and priced for Namibian properties.

Revenue model

Pricing is per site, so revenue grows with every branch a lodge group adds. Annual billing charges ten months for twelve. Guests never pay, and there is no per-visit fee: a busy weekend costs a property nothing extra.

PLAN	BEST FOR	MONTHLY PRICE	SITES INCLUDED	EACH EXTRA SITE
Site	One hotel, lodge or guesthouse	N\$1,500	1	Not available
Network	Lodge groups and hotel chains	N\$4,500	3	N\$950
Assure	Properties with higher-assurance needs	N\$9,500	3	N\$1,500

The screenshot shows a pricing interface with the following details:

- Toggles:** Monthly (selected), Annual; How many sites? 1
- Site Plan:** One office, branch, or clinic; N\$ 1,500 / month; Priced for 1 site (1 site included); Unlimited visits.
- Network Plan (Recommended):** Branch networks, clinic groups, corporate offices; N\$ 4,500 / month; Priced for 1 site (3 sites included, then N\$ 950 per extra site a month); Everything in Site.
- Assure Plan:** Government and regulated institutions; N\$ 9,500 / month; Priced for 1 site (3 sites included, then N\$ 1,500 per extra site a month); Everything in Network.

The live pricing page at buffrcheckpoint.com/pricing on 30 September 2026. A property enters its number of sites and sees the monthly price for each plan.

Business Model Canvas

KEY PARTNERS

- Hotel Etuna, Ongwediva (first pilot site)
- CiMSO, whose INNkeeper software runs many Namibian lodges (integration)
- Namibia Tourism Board (register and monthly returns format)
- Hospitality Association of Namibia (member cohorts)
- Ministry of Information and Communication Technology (data protection readiness)
- Development Bank of Namibia
- Licensed payment gateway (card and instant payments)
- Cloud hosting and email delivery providers

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Build and harden the check-in platform
- Install and train front desks
- Run measured pilots
- Integrate with booking systems such as CiMSO INNkeeper

KEY RESOURCES

- Production software, live today
- Founders' hospitality, payments and field-systems experience
- A family property for real-world testing

VALUE PROPOSITIONS

- Guests stop reading each other's details in a shared book
- The legal guest register is produced as a by-product of check-in
- Every guest can check in: own phone, receptionist, or optional self-service tablet
- Keeps working through power and network outages
- Emergency roster of who is on the property
- Ready for data protection law before it arrives
- No hardware needed to start

CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS

- Self-service signup and setup
- Hands-on onboarding for pilot and group properties
- Local support by phone and email

CHANNELS

- buffrcheckpoint.com self-service signup
- Founder-led sales to lodge groups
- Association and Tourism Board introductions
- Reference sites after pilots
- Payment by transfer, card or instant payment

CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

- **First:** registered hotels, lodges, guesthouses and bed and breakfasts in Namibia
- **Next:** lodge groups and chains, tourism attractions with day visitors
- **Later:** corporate and public reception desks; Southern African lodging
- Guests use the product; properties pay

COST STRUCTURE

- Engineering and product time
- Hosting, storage and email delivery
- Installation, training and support hours
- Optional demonstration tablets
- Payment gateway fees

REVENUE STREAMS

- Site N\$1,500 per month (1 site, unlimited visits)
- Network N\$4,500 per month (3 sites) plus N\$950 per extra site
- Assure N\$9,500 per month (3 sites) plus N\$1,500 per extra site
- Tablet and badge hardware sold or leased separately

Unit economics and break-even

Management estimates at 30 September 2026, using the low-tech marketing math method: contribution per site covers fixed costs, and break-even volume is fixed costs divided by contribution per site (Dolan, 1998).

FIXED COSTS	PER MONTH	VARIABLE COST PER SITE	PER MONTH
Founders' pay (two founders)	N\$30,000	Hosting and email for the site	N\$50
Cloud hosting, database and storage	N\$2,600	Support, one hour at N\$250 (two hours on Assure)	N\$250
Email delivery, monitoring and domains	N\$1,050	Payment gateway fee, about 3 percent of the invoice	N\$45
Software, accounting, insurance, phone and data	N\$2,350	Total on Site	N\$345
Marketing and travel	N\$6,000		
Total	N\$42,000		

PLAN	MONTHLY PRICE	VARIABLE COST	CONTRIBUTION	MARGIN
Site (1 site)	N\$1,500	N\$345	N\$1,155	77.0%
Network (3 sites)	N\$4,500	N\$1,035	N\$3,465	77.0%
Network, each extra site	N\$950	N\$328	N\$622	65.4%
Assure (3 sites)	N\$9,500	N\$1,935	N\$7,565	79.6%
Assure, each extra site	N\$1,500	N\$595	N\$905	60.3%

Break-even is 37 sites. N\$42,000 in fixed costs divided by N\$1,155 contribution per Site gives 36.4, so 37 paying sites cover the business. At the top of the Year 1 range, 30 sites contribute N\$34,650 a month, a gap of N\$7,350 a month that the Award would close while the pilots run. If fixed costs double to N\$84,000 when we hire two support staff, break-even moves to 73 sites, inside the Year 2 range of 60 to 100.

Onboarding pays back in under two months. Setting up and training a new site costs about N\$1,500 once (half a day on site plus travel), which one Site subscription recovers in 1.3 months.

Price is highly leveraged, so we do not discount. A 20 percent price cut to N\$1,200 lowers contribution per site by 25 percent to N\$864 and raises break-even from 37 to 49 sites. A 20 percent rise to N\$1,800 lifts contribution to N\$1,446 and lowers break-even to 30 sites.

The Namibia Tourism Board's register holds the exact number of registered establishments. We will ask for that count in our pilot proposal to the Board, so break-even can also be stated as a share of the market.

Situation analysis: the five Cs

FACTOR	WHAT IT MEANS FOR CHECKPOINT
Customers	Registered hotels, lodges and guesthouses must keep a guest register and file monthly returns (Regulations Relating to the Registration of Accommodation Establishments, 2004). Owners want guest privacy, a fast desk, a register that is always ready and a system that keeps working in outages.
Company	A live product, founders who grew up in hospitality, experience in payments and field systems, and a family hotel as the first pilot.
Competition	The paper book is free but exposes every guest. Imported visitor tools are priced per location in foreign currency. Property management systems handle bookings and billing, not the private front door.
Collaborators	CiMSO for booking data, a licensed payment gateway for card and instant payments, the Namibia Tourism Board, the Hospitality Association of Namibia, the Ministry of Information and Communication Technology and the Development Bank of Namibia.
Context	The Data Protection Bill is close to law (New Era, 2026), power and network outages are common outside the main towns, and smartphone ownership is uneven.

Marketing mix: the four Ps

ELEMENT	DECISION
Product	Private check-in for every guest, the legal register as a by-product, the optional offline reception tablet, badges for regular visitors and the CiMSO integration.
Price	Per site, in Namibia dollars: Site, Network and Assure. Annual billing charges ten months for twelve. No per-visit fee.
Place	Self-service signup at buffrcheckpoint.com, founder-led sales to lodge groups, and installation and training by our own team. Properties pay by electronic funds transfer, or by card or instant payment through our payment gateway partner.
Promotion	Planned with the six Ms below.

Promotion plan: the six Ms

ELEMENT	PLAN
Market	Owners and front-desk managers of registered accommodation, starting in the northern regions, then lodge groups nationally.
Mission	Publish the Hotel Etuna pilot results, reach 30 paying sites in Year 1 and pass break-even (37 sites) early in Year 2.
Message	"Your guests' details stay private, and your register is always ready for the Tourism Board."
Media	Demonstrations at properties along the northern route, reference visits to Hotel Etuna, Hospitality Association events, Tourism Board introductions, LinkedIn and WhatsApp Business. Every QR stand at a live desk shows the Checkpoint name to arriving guests.
Money	N\$6,000 a month (N\$72,000 in Year 1), already inside fixed costs.
Measurement	Signups, pilot-to-paid conversion, cost to win a site (target under N\$4,000, about three and a half months of contribution), check-in time and cancellations.

How we compare

Imported visitor-management tools charge per location, in foreign currency. Prices below were read from each vendor's pricing page on 29 September 2026 and converted at approximately N\$20.5 per euro and N\$17.5 per United States dollar.

PRODUCT	PLAN	APPROXIMATE MONTHLY COST PER LOCATION	NOTES
Vizito (Vizito, n.d.)	Standard to Enterprise	N\$615 to N\$2,050	Lower plans cap visits at 100 or 300 a month
Envoy (Envoy, n.d.)	Premium	about N\$6,300	Billed annually in United States dollars
Checkpoint	Site	N\$1,500	Unlimited visits, local billing and support, works offline

A lodge group with 20 sites would pay N\$20,650 a month on Network, compared with about N\$41,000 on Vizito's top plan and about N\$126,000 on Envoy Premium.

Go-to-market

- 1. Prove it at home.** Run Checkpoint at Hotel Etuna in Ongwediva and measure check-in time, paper fallbacks and time to answer "who was on the property on a given night".
- 2. Connect to the lodges' own systems.** Switch on the CiMSO connection at the first pilot lodge that runs CiMSO INNkeeper, so expected arrivals appear in Checkpoint automatically.

3. **Grow through trusted networks.** With introductions from the Development Bank of Namibia, run a ten-property cohort with the Hospitality Association of Namibia and propose a register and monthly-returns pilot with the Namibia Tourism Board.
4. **Scale self-service.** Properties sign up online, set up their sites, and go live once their first payment clears.

Pilot milestones

Each assumption has a test and a clear pass signal.

NO.	ASSUMPTION	TEST	PASS SIGNAL
1	Front desks still use shared books or open lists for guests and walk-ins	Interviews with front-desk managers about last week's process	Two of three describe shared visibility
2	Properties will pay N\$1,500 per month after a 60 to 90 day pilot	Paid pilot at Hotel Etuna and one other property	Payment received; paper fallbacks fall
3	Phone check-in plus the receptionist covers at least 90 percent of arrivals	Channel mix during the pilot	Completion of 90 percent or more
4	At least one pilot site type needs the offline tablet	Include one low-connectivity site	Offline capture and sync measured
5	"Who was here last Tuesday" can be answered in 15 minutes or less	Timed drill at a pilot site	Measured time of 15 minutes or less
6	The cost of winning a site stays under N\$4,000	Track hours and travel per signed property	Under N\$4,000 per site

Five-year revenue outlook

YEAR	SITES	ANNUAL RECURRING REVENUE
Year 1	15 to 30	N\$0.3m to N\$0.7m
Year 2	60 to 100	N\$1.1m to N\$2.4m
Year 3	120 to 180	N\$2.2m to N\$4.3m
Year 4	200 to 280	N\$3.6m to N\$6.7m
Year 5	300 to 400	N\$5.4m to N\$9.6m

Assumes a blended N\$1,500 to N\$2,000 per site per month. Break-even at current fixed costs is 37 sites.

Abbreviations

CC	Close corporation
N\$	Namibia dollar

References

Dolan, R. J. (1998). *Note on low-tech marketing math* (Harvard Business School Note No. 9-599-011). Harvard Business School Publishing.

Envoy. (n.d.). *Pricing*. Retrieved September 29, 2026, from <https://envoy.com/pricing>

New Era. (2026, January 27). *Data legislations under final polishing*. <https://neweralive.na/data-legislations-under-final-polishing/>

Regulations Relating to the Registration of Accommodation Establishments, Government Notice No. 139 of 2004, Government Gazette No. 3235 (2004) (Namibia).
<https://www.lac.org.na/laws/annoREG/Namibia%20Tourism%20Board%20Act%2021%20of%202000%20-%20Regulations%202004-139.pdf>

Vizito. (n.d.). *Plans and pricing*. Retrieved September 29, 2026, from <https://vizito.eu/pricing/>